



PROPOSAL FOR

IMPACT EVALUATION OF NATIONAL PENSION SCHEME FOR TRADERS

PREPARED BY –



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1. ABOUT QUALITY COUNCIL OF INDIA

Quality Council of India (QCI) has been set up as a non-profit autonomous society to establish and operate the national accreditation system in the country and to spread quality movement in India by undertaking a national quality campaign. It was formed in 1997 by a joint initiative of the Government of India and the Indian Industry associations like the Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India (ASSOCHAM), Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) and Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI).

QCI has established constituent boards, divisions, and cells to address various aspects of quality. These boards are active participants in international accreditation systems and are part of multilateral mutual recognition arrangements (MRAs/MLAs), ensuring global equivalence and recognition of conformity assessment results. It also facilitates the design, development and implementation of initiatives that leverage the strength of its accredited bodies in providing independent, impartial, and credible mechanisms for assuring quality across spheres of life. In the past 10 years, QCI is engaged with 90+ ministries and departments of the Union and State Governments in executing 400+ projects across multivariate spheres.

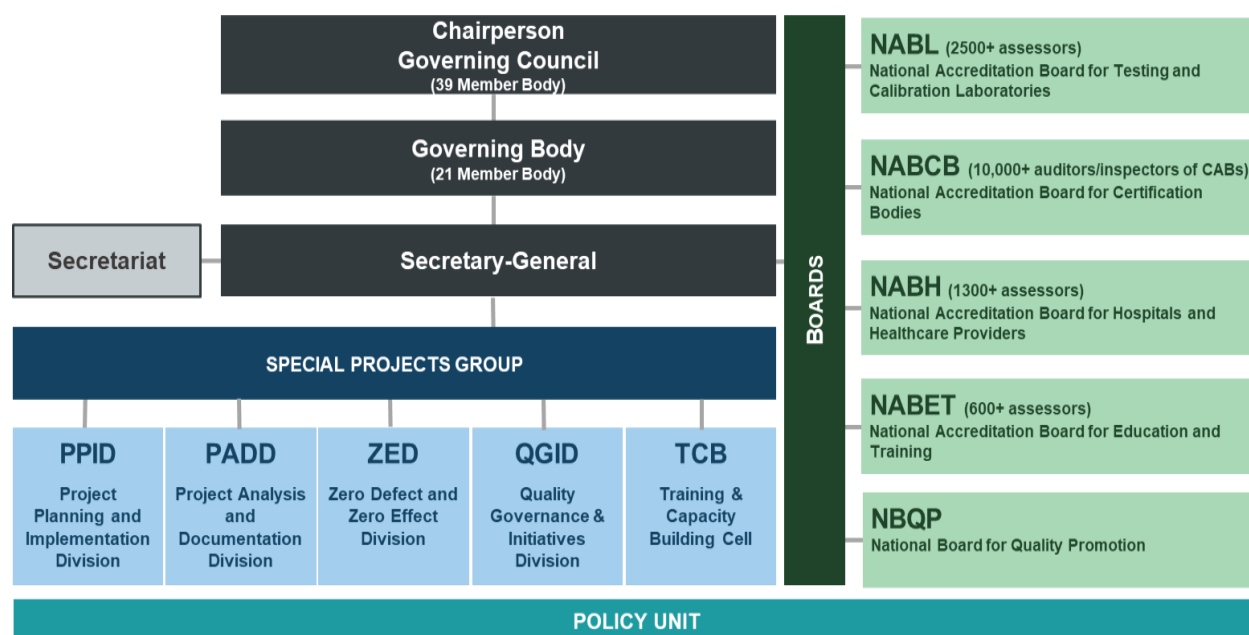


Figure 1: QCI Organization Structure

Constituent Boards

- **National Accreditation Board for Testing & Calibration Laboratories (NABL):** NABL is a constituent board of QCI that accredits laboratories across scopes. NABL is a Mutual Recognition Arrangement (MRA) signatory member of APAC (Asia Pacific Accreditation Cooperation) and ILAC (International Laboratory Accreditation Cooperation) since 2000.

NABL in the year 2016 achieved the APAC MRA signatory status for Proficiency Testing Providers (PTP) and Reference Material Producers (RMP) schemes along with extension in the existing fields of Testing, Calibration and Medical till December 2020. NABL has also obtained ILAC MRA for Proficiency Testing Providers (PTP) accreditation program (ISO/IEC 17043) in addition to existing Testing including Medical (ISO/IEC 17025 and ISO 15189) and Calibration (ISO/IEC 17025) programs.

- **National Accreditation Board for Certification Bodies (NABCB):** Provides accreditation to Certification, Inspection, and Validation/Verification Bodies based on assessment of their competence as per international standards. NABCB is a full member of the International Accreditation Forum (IAF), International Laboratory Accreditation Cooperation (ILAC) and Asia Pacific Accreditation Cooperation (APAC).
- **National Accreditation Board for Hospitals and Healthcare Providers (NABH):** Provides accreditation to hospitals and other healthcare organisations. NABH is a member of the International Society for Quality in Healthcare (IsQua) and its accreditations are internationally accepted. It is also a member of the Asian Society for Quality in Healthcare.
- **National Accreditation Board for Education & Training (NABET):** Committed to improving the quality of education, training, and skill development in India. It provides accreditation to schools, training institutions, and skill development organizations based on globally recognized standards. NABET also develops frameworks and guidelines to ensure excellence in education delivery and fosters continuous improvement. By promoting best practices and certifying institutions.
- **National Board for Quality Promotion (NBQP):** Dedicated to promoting a culture of quality across various sectors in India. It focuses on enhancing competitiveness through capacity building, certifications, and the adoption of best practices. NBQP conducts training programs, workshops, and seminars to equip professionals and organizations with quality skills while offering certification schemes aligned with national and international standards.

Special Projects Group (Cells and Divisions)

- **Project Planning and Implementation Division (PPID):** Specialises in conceptualising, planning, and executing Government Flagship Schemes as required by various Government Ministries/Departments and strategy and Policy Projects that drive quality improvements across various sectors in India. This division focuses on delivering comprehensive solutions tailored to enhance efficiency, compliance, and innovation in line with national and organisational objectives. The PPID undertakes end-to-end project management responsibilities that include strategic planning, Monitoring and Evaluation, Implementation and Stakeholder Management.
- **Projects Analysis and Documentation Division (PADD):** Handles various voluntary certification schemes like the Voluntary Certification Scheme for Medicinal Plant Produce

(VCSMPP), and INDG.A.P., Ready Mix Concrete Plant Certification Scheme (RMCPSC), Certification Scheme for Unmanned Aircraft Systems (UAS) etc.

- **Zero Defect and Zero Effect Division (ZED):** Aims at enhancing the global competitiveness of MSMEs by gauging the manufacturer's maturity in several disciplines and gradually building their capabilities to become world class. The ZED Maturity Assessment Model has been conceived and structured to offer graded benchmark levels of an organization's performance through a set of standard enablers and outcomes focused on quality, environmental and other performance indices.
- **Quality Governance and Initiatives Division (QGID):** Implements mass-outreach programmes and initiatives of QCI such as Sarpanch Samvaad, Industry Connect, Gunvatta Sankalp etc.
- **Training & Capacity Building (TCB) Cell:** Offers various training programmes and e-learning modules for knowledge and skill enhancement of various stakeholders. Also, coordinates with national and international organisations regarding their training & capacity building needs.
- **Policy Unit:** Specialized Unit complementing and augmenting the capacity of the government in policy-making, especially in the field of quality. It provides services in the following domains: (a) quality evaluation of goods, services, programmes, , processes, and organizations, (b) strategic research and advisory in regulation, policy, quality, technology, and population scale transformations, and (c) knowledge development and analysis for emerging/futures policies.

Similar Past Experience

- **THIRD PARTY EVALUATION OF THREE CENTRAL SECTOR SCHEMES:** QCI conducted an evaluation of three Central Sector schemes under the Ministry of Labour & Employment—e-Shram Portal, National Career Service (NCS), and Coaching and Guidance for SC/ST (NCSC for SC/ST). The assessment focused on measuring the schemes relevance, effectiveness, efficiency, sustainability, and socio-economic impact. Through comprehensive data collection using structured questionnaires across multiple states, QCI identified gaps, documented best practices, and provided actionable recommendations to enhance service delivery, broaden coverage, and support the schemes' future improvement.
- **START-UP VILLAGE ENTREPRENEURSHIP PROGRAMME:** The Start-up Village Entrepreneurship Programme (SVEP), a sub-scheme under the National Rural Livelihood Mission, aims to promote rural enterprises and self-employment by supporting sustainable livelihoods through financial assistance and training across 24 states, targeting 3.78 lakh rural poor. QCI conducted a comprehensive survey in all 24 states to assess the scheme's contribution, identify best practices, and evaluate implementation. The assessment focused

on mobilizing communities, strengthening institutional structures, and building capacities. Through its mid-term evaluation, QCI provided strategic insights to enhance the scheme's sustainability and expand enterprise development, along with key recommendations on promoting new enterprises and strengthening the role of CRP-Eps.

- **IMPACT EVALAUTION OF LIVELIHOOD PROJECTS UNDERTAKEN BY SASAKAWA-INDIA LEPROSY FOUNDATION:** QCI conducted the Impact Evaluation project to assess the tangible effects of S-ILF's interventions on beneficiaries in Champa district, Chhattisgarh. The evaluation examined outcomes such as skill development, income generation, and resource access to assess how these initiatives promoted socio-economic inclusion and improved well-being. Through rigorous data collection and analysis, QCI measured indicators like employment, healthcare, and quality of life, highlighting the impact of S-ILF's efforts on poverty reduction, livelihood enhancement, and empowerment of beneficiaries and their families.
- **SOCIO ECONOMIC PROFILING OF STREET VENDORS UNDER PM SVANIDHI SCHEME AND THEIR FAMILIES:** QCI conducted an evaluation of the Pradhan Mantri Street Vendor Atmanirbhar Nidhi (PM SVANidhi) scheme, launched by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs in response to the economic impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on street vendors. The assessment focused on the scheme's core objectives: providing working capital loans up to ₹10,000, incentivizing timely repayments, and promoting digital transactions. QCI evaluated the scheme's implementation, outreach, and impact on vendor livelihoods, and offered insights to strengthen delivery mechanisms and financial inclusion.
- **IMPACT EVALUATION STUDY OF HERITAGE CITY DEVELOPMENT AND AUGMENTATION YOJANA (HRIDAY) SCHEME:** The Heritage City Development and Augmentation Yojana (HRIDAY), initiated by the Ministry of Urban Development, aimed to preserve and showcase the unique heritage of 12 identified cities in India from 2015 to 2019. QCI conducted an Impact Assessment Study in 2023 to evaluate the scheme's impact on revitalizing heritage areas and enhancing overall quality of life. The study involved a multidisciplinary team and utilized a citizen perception survey covering dimensions such as sanitation, security, tourism, heritage revitalization, livelihoods.
- **IMPACT ASSESSMENT OF NATIONAL URBAN LIVELIHOODS MISSION (NULM)-MID TERM EVALAUTION OF DEENDAYAL ANTYODAYA YOJANA:** QCI conducted an evaluation of the Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana-National Urban Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NULM), an initiative by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs to reduce urban poverty. The assessment focused on key components including SHG mobilization (SMID), skill training and placement (ESTP), support for micro-enterprises (SEP), shelters for the homeless (SUH), and assistance to street vendors (SUSV). QCI evaluated the implementation effectiveness, reach, and

outcomes of these components, identifying best practices, assessing beneficiary impact, and recommending strategies for improved livelihood support, financial inclusion, and institutional strengthening.

2. PROJECT OVERVIEW

The National Pension Scheme for Traders aims to provide old-age social security to small traders and self-employed individuals in the unorganised sector. This evaluation, guided by the REESI+C+E framework, will assess socio-economic impact, key challenges, and implementation gaps through field surveys, interviews, and stakeholder consultations. By analysing both quantitative data and Most Significant Change (MSC) narratives, the study will generate actionable, evidence-based recommendations to enhance scheme delivery and scalability. A structured weekly plan will ensure timely completion within the one-month timeline.

3. OBJECTIVE

The below are the defined objectives of QCI:

Impact Evaluation of Scheme:

To systematically study and evaluate the impact of the scheme on the overall beneficiaries. This involves assessing the effectiveness of the scheme by the REESI+C+E (Relevance, Effectiveness, Efficiency, Sustainability, Impact, Coherence and Equity) framework in achieving their intended outcomes and determining the overall benefit to the beneficiaries.

Output-Outcome Analysis:

To conduct a comprehensive output-outcome analysis of the scheme, examining the direct outputs produced and their subsequent outcomes to assess the success and efficiency of the scheme in achieving its goals.

Process Evaluation:

To undertake a detailed process evaluation to:

- Identify Gaps in Implementation: Investigate any discrepancies or shortcomings in the execution of the scheme.
- Assess Alignment with Scheme Design: Evaluate how closely the implementation processes adhere to the original design and objectives of the scheme.
- Suggest Improvement Measures: Propose actionable recommendations for enhancing the effectiveness and efficiency of the scheme implementation in the future.

Recommendations for Continuation:

To provide recommendations regarding the continuation of the scheme. This includes evaluating the sustainability of the scheme and providing suggestions on whether it should be maintained or reformed based on the findings.

Recommendations for Extension of Scope:

To provide recommendations for expanding the scope of the scheme in terms of sectoral coverage. This involves identifying potential areas or sectors where the scheme could be extended to maximize its impact and benefits for beneficiaries.

4. SCOPE OF WORK

Ministry of Labor and Employment (MoLE) has commissioned a comprehensive third-party evaluation of the **National Pension Scheme for Traders (NPS-Traders)**. This assessment will examine the performance of the scheme across critical dimensions such as effectiveness, equity, efficiency, and its potential for sustained implementation. Below is the detailed scope of work outlining the key components and methodologies of the evaluation.

1. Project Understanding and Objective

The evaluation will comprehensively examine the National Pension Scheme for Traders using the REESI+C+E framework, focusing on its relevance, effectiveness, efficiency, sustainability, impact, coherence, and equity. It will assess the actual outcomes and benefits experienced by the enrolled beneficiaries, determining how well the scheme has met its intended objectives. Based on the findings, the evaluation will also provide strategic recommendations regarding the continuation of the scheme and explore possibilities for extending its scope to cover additional sectors or beneficiary groups.

2. Scheme Evaluation Scope

The evaluation will focus on multiple dimensions:

- **Impact Evaluation** to measure socio-economic outcomes and benefits realized by beneficiaries.
- **Output-Outcome Analysis** to assess the relationship between scheme inputs (e.g., enrolments and pension disbursements) and outcomes (e.g., income security and social inclusion).
- **Process Evaluation** will identify implementation gaps, assess alignment with scheme design, and suggest improvements.
- **Policy Recommendations** will be made on the continuation or reform of the scheme, and the feasibility of expanding its scope to other sectors.

3. Evaluation Framework and Methodology

The evaluation will follow a structured REESI+C+E framework, employing mixed-methods research including surveys, interviews, focus group discussions (FGDs), and review of secondary data. A SWOT analysis will also be conducted to identify internal strengths and external challenges, along with potential areas for enhancement.

4. Phased Approach

The evaluation will be carried out in five sequential phases:

A. Conception and Initiation Phase

This phase involves stakeholder identification and engagement planning, evaluation indicator finalization, resource allocation (human, technical, and financial), and preparation of a robust data collection strategy.

B. Design Phase

Evaluation indicators will be developed based on REESI+C+E and socio-economic objectives. Structured questionnaires will be created, and assessors from NABCB-accredited bodies will be hired and trained. A multi-stage stratified sampling strategy will be implemented, supported by GIS tools for mapping and visualization. A total of 1,000 beneficiaries will be sampled across the following regions:

- North (Uttar Pradesh/Delhi NCR) – 400
- West (Gujarat) – 300
- North-East (Assam) – 300

C. Implementation Phase

Primary data collection will be conducted through personal and virtual interviews. A central coordination team based in New Delhi will manage and monitor data quality, ensuring real-time review, validation, and ethical field practices.

D. Analysis Phase

Collected data will be analyzed using statistical methods such as frequency distribution, inferential analysis, and geospatial mapping. Analysis will cover:

- **Efficiency** through cost-benefit assessment
- **Outputs and Outcomes** like pension delivery and utilization
- **Social Parameters** such as inclusion and demographic reach
- **Economic Impact** in terms of income and employment changes
- **Financial Indicators** focusing on budget utilization

The results will be presented visually through bar charts, heat maps, and other statistical tools.

E. Reporting Phase

A comprehensive evaluation report will be compiled, including an executive summary, detailed analysis, and annexures. Findings will be presented in a stakeholder workshop. Based on feedback, a final report will be submitted, along with presentations.

5. EXPECTED OUTCOME

The **expected outcomes** from the **Impact Evaluation of the NPS Traders Scheme by QCI** will include:

1. Comprehensive Assessment Report

A detailed evaluation report covering the scheme's performance across REESI+C+E

(Relevance, Effectiveness, Efficiency, Sustainability, Impact, Coherence, and Equity) parameters.

2. Beneficiary Insights

Evidence-based understanding of beneficiary awareness, enrolment experience, satisfaction levels, and socio-economic impact, including qualitative feedback and Most Significant Change (MSC) stories.

3. Implementation Gaps and Bottlenecks

Identification of key operational challenges, regional variations, and factors limiting scheme uptake or impact.

4. Policy and Design Recommendations

Actionable suggestions to improve targeting, outreach, delivery mechanisms, and integration with other welfare schemes like e-Shram and PM-SVANidhi.

5. Scalability Roadmap

Strategic inputs to help MoLE to design a scalable and replicable model for nationwide expansion of the scheme.

6. Stakeholder Feedback Integration

Summary of feedback from state/district-level implementing agencies, beneficiaries, and local trade associations to inform policy refinement.

6. PROJECT TIMELINE

The overall project timeline for the NPS Traders Scheme evaluation is one month, during which all key activities—from planning and data collection to analysis and reporting—will be completed. The detailed timeline is as mentioned below, outlining specific tasks and milestones for each phase of the project to ensure a systematic and timely completion.

Task Title	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4
1 Initiation & Design				
1.1 Key-Off Meeting with Client				
1.2 Stakeholder Mapping & Engagement				
1.3 Questionnaire & Sampling Methodology Development				
1.4 Hiring and Training of Assessors				
2 Implementation				
2.1 Data Assurance and Collection Method				
2.2 Personal Interview				
2.3 Data Validation & Mnagement				
3 Analysis				
3.1 Data Analysis on Various Parameters				
4 Reporting				
4.1 Reporting & Presentation				
4.2 Stakeholder Review and Feedback				
4.3 Submission of Final Report				

7. BUDGET ESTIMATION

The primary component of this budget is allocated towards the human resource costs of QCI professionals and assessors, whose expertise and extensive experience in executing similar projects will ensure the delivery of high-quality outcomes

Case: 50% on Ground Assessment and 50% Virtual Assessment

Client Quotation							
Headers	Line Item	Particulars	Unit	Unit cost	Qty.	Duration	Total (INR)
(A) Central Team	1	Analyst (End-to-end implementation & monitoring of project)	Man-month	60,000	7	1	₹ 4,20,000
	2	Cost against Heading (A)					₹ 4,20,000
(B) On-Site Team	3	Assessor Cost	Man-day	2,500	4	5	₹ 50,000
	4	Cost against Heading (B)					₹ 50,000
(C) Logistics and Travel Cost	5	Logistics and Travel Cost (Local Travel)					₹ 20,000
	6	Cost against Heading (C)					₹ 20,000
(D) Technology Cost	7	Report Designing Tool					₹ 10,000
		IT Tool					₹ 15,000
	8	Cost against Heading (D)					₹ 25,000
(E)	9	Sub-Total (SUM of Line Item 2,4,6,8)					₹ 5,15,000
Cumulation	10	Admin Cost (@12% of Line Item 9)					₹ 61,800
	11	Total (SUM of Line Item 9, 10) (Exclusive of GST)					₹ 5,76,800
						with GST	₹6,80,624.00

***Note:**

- ^Taxes and GST extra as applicable.
- *Human Resources costs will be charged as per actuals, if scope and timeline are extended in case of delay arising out of MoLE, the same will be done with due consultation with MoLE.
- **Administrative Cost includes, technology costs, Maintenance Cost

Payment Schedule for the Project

S.No	Schedule/ Milestones	Payment
1	Interest-free mobilization advance	40%
2	On submission of the Mid-Term / Draft Report	30%
3	On submission of the Final Report	30%

8. GENERAL TERMS

- 1) **AMENDMENT OF AGREEMENT:** No amendment or modification of the agreement authorising this project shall be valid unless it is made in writing jointly by both parties or by their authorized representatives and specially stating the reason for amendment to this agreement. The modification/changes shall be effective from the date of which they are made/executed unless otherwise agreed to.
- 2) **FORCE MAJEURE:** The parties shall ensure due compliance with the terms of this agreement. However, no party shall be liable for any claim for any loss or damage whatsoever arising out of failure to carry out the terms of the agreement to the extent such a failure is due to force majeure events such as fire, rebellion, mutiny, civil commotion, riots, strike, lockout, force of nature, accident, act of God, or any other reason beyond the control of concerned party.
- 3) **ARBITRATION:** The disputes, if arising, shall be settled by arbitration with sole arbitrator (to be jointly appointed in 30 days) in accordance with the procedure prescribed in the Indian Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996 or any statutory modification or re-enactment thereof and the rules made thereunder and for the time being in force. Proceedings shall, unless otherwise agreed by the parties, to be held in Delhi, India. Governing law will be laws of India. Language will be English.
- 4) **NOTICE:** All notices permitted or required to be given under the provisions of this agreement shall be deemed to be sufficiently given if written and delivered personally or sent to the other party by telefax or certified or registered air mail or email and addressed to the registered office of the other party as follows or to such other party address as the party may give notice in writing. Unless otherwise provided herein all such notices shall be deemed to have been given as of the date they are personally delivered or transmitted by telefax or email or deposited in the mail.
- 5) **TERMINATION OF AGREEMENT:** Either party shall have the right to terminate the agreement at any time by giving thirty days' notice in writing in advance indicating reasons for same to the other party. The reasons however, will need to be justified and in case the termination leads to delay/pause/abortion of the project, the Authority

reserves the right to not make any payments further to the date of project termination as indicated by either party.

- 6) **INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY:** The intellectual property created during the course of this project, including but not limited to designs, written content, and any other creative or inventive work, shall be the exclusive property of QCI. MoLE shall be granted a non-exclusive license to use said intellectual property solely for the purposes outlined in this proposal. Any transfer of ownership or additional licensing terms must be agreed upon in writing by both parties.
- 7) **CONFIDENTIALITY:** Both parties agree to maintain strict confidentiality regarding all project-related information, documents, and data disclosed during the execution of this proposal. Any breach of this confidentiality agreement may result in legal action and remedies as deemed appropriate.
- 8) **INDEMNIFICATION:** Each party agrees to indemnify, defend, and hold harmless the other party from and against any claims, liabilities, and expenses arising out of their actions or negligence.
- 9) **CHANGE AND AMENDMENTS:** Any modifications or amendments to the Scope of Work or project timeline shall be documented in writing and mutually agreed upon by both parties. Such changes may result in adjustments to the applicable fees. In the event of a delay arising from MoLE or any third party, any resulting extension of the timeline will incur financial implications on MoLE. The agreed financial rates will remain applicable during the extended period, subject to concurrence by MoLE.
- 10) **CODE OF INTEGRITY:** Each party should observe the highest standard of ethics and should not indulge in the following prohibited practices, either directly or indirectly, at any stage during the process or during execution of resultant contracts, failing which Corporation may consider to terminate the contract:
 - i. **Anti-competitive practice:** any collusion, bid rigging or anti-competitive arrangement, or any other practice coming under the purview of The Competition Act, 2002, between two or more consultant, with or without the knowledge of any party.
 - ii. **Corrupt practice:** making offers, solicitation or acceptance of bribe, rewards or gifts or any material benefit, in exchange for an unfair advantage in the procurement process or to otherwise influence the procurement process or contract execution;
 - iii. **Fraudulent practice:** any omission or misrepresentation that may mislead or attempt to mislead so that financial or other benefits may be obtained or an obligation avoided. This includes making false declaration or providing false information for participation in a tender process or to secure a contract or in execution of the contract.